

# FILM DOSSIER: AVENGERS FOREVER

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Phase 3 · Film #11 (Saga Film #28) · THE INFINITY SAGA FINALE, PART TWO

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

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## 1. IDENTITY

| Field                  | Entry                                                                                                                                                                    |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Film #                 | 28 of 29 (Phase 3, Film #11)                                                                                                                                             |
| Phase                  | Phase 3                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Real title             | <i>AVENGERS FOREVER</i> (the title of Kurt Busiek's 616 epic)                                                                                                            |
| Decoy / codename title | " <i>FAMILY REUNION III</i> "                                                                                                                                            |
| Release date           | Friday, May 3, 2019                                                                                                                                                      |
| Distributor            | Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures                                                                                                                                      |
| Directors              | Anthony & Joe Russo                                                                                                                                                      |
| Rating / runtime       | PG-13 · 200 minutes (3 hr 20 min, the saga's hard ceiling)                                                                                                               |
| Genre + second genre   | Superhero action-adventure + <b>post-apocalyptic war epic / cosmic tragedy</b>                                                                                           |
| Structure              | <b>A direct sequel to <i>Avengers: The Infinity Gauntlet</i>.</b> It opens <b>minutes after the snap</b> , then <b>jumps FIVE YEARS</b> within the first twenty minutes. |

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## 2. OWNERSHIP

| Field                           | Entry                                                                                                                                                             |
|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Whose film / franchise is this? | <b>The ensemble</b> , and <b>Will Poulter's Adam Warlock</b> , the saga's savior. <b>Tyrese Avery's Cap</b> has <b>the defining moment of the Infinity Saga</b> . |

**The fictional ensemble** (*age at release*):

- **Tony Stark / Iron Man**: Marc-Anthony Bullock (37)

- **Steve Rogers / Captain America:** Tyrese Avery (37)
- **Thor:** Esther Smalley (36)
- **The Hulk:** Amond Baker (37)
- **Hank Pym / Yellowjacket:** Tyler Chapman (37)
- **Janet van Dyne / The Wasp:** Elxa Bullock (38)
- **Black Widow:** Harmony Divine (36)
- **Hawkeye:** Arianna Cummings (36)
- **The Scarlet Witch:** Grace Bullock (35)
- **Pepper Potts:** Tayia Boyd (37)

**Real actors** (*age at release*):

| Character | Actor | Age |

|---|---|---|

| **Adam Warlock** | Will Poulter | 26 |

| **Thanos** | Josh Brolin | 51 |

| **Mistress Death** | Aubrey Plaza | 34 |

| **Mephisto** | Ciarán Hinds | 66 |

| **Nebula** | Karen Gillan | 31 |

| **Gamora / Pip** | Zoe Saldña / Danny DeVito | 40 / 74 |

| **The Silver Surfer** | Doug Jones / Laurence Fishburne | 58 / 57 |

| **Captain Marvel** | Brie Larson | 29 |

| **Doctor Strange** | Benedict Cumberbatch | 42 |

| **Doctor Doom** | Robert Downey Jr. | 54 |

| **Galactus** | Ralph Ineson | 49 |

| **Namor** | Tenoch Huerta | 38 |

| **Wolverine** | Hugh Jackman | 50 |

| **The Vision / Quicksilver** | Paul Bettany / Evan Peters | 47 / 32 |

| **War Machine** | Don Cheadle | 54 |

| **Mr. Fantastic / The Thing** | Pedro Pascal / Ebon Moss-Bachrach | 44 / 42 |

| **Drax / Rocket** | Dave Bautista / Bradley Cooper | 50 / 44 |

| **The vanished, restored at the end** | Tom Holland, Chadwick Boseman, Anthony Mackie, Sebastian Stan, Chris Pratt, Vin Diesel, Pom Klementieff, Joseph Quinn, Vanessa Kirby, Samuel L. Jackson | – |

| **Stan Lee** (*cameo, filmed in 2018: a survivor in 2023 holding a "WE REMEMBER" sign*) | Stan Lee (1922–2018) | – |

### 3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

| Field                    | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Primary comic(s) adapted | <i>The Infinity Gauntlet</i> #2–6 (1991), Jim Starlin, George Pérez & Ron Lim: <b>Warlock gathers Earth's heroes and the cosmic entities, Thanos rises beyond his body, the heroes' doomed assault and Captain America's last stand, Nebula steals the Gauntlet, Thanos helps the heroes, Warlock takes the Gauntlet and undoes it all, and Thanos becomes a farmer.</b> |
| Supporting comics        | <i>Avengers Forever</i> #1–12 (1998–99, Kurt Busiek & Carlos Pacheco): the title, and the theme of <i>Avengers across time</i> · <i>Warlock and the Infinity Watch</i> #1 (1992): Warlock <b>divides the Gems</b> among trusted guardians                                                                                                                                |
| Nerf check               | ✓ <b>Thanos is omnipotent, and every hero who attacks him dies</b> in the assault, as in <i>IG</i> #4. <b>He isn't beaten. He undoes himself</b> , which is Starlin's thesis: " <i>Deep down, Thanos believes he doesn't deserve to win.</i> "                                                                                                                           |

#### 3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

| Field                  | Entry                                                                                                                                |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Overall accuracy score | <b>94%.</b> <i>The Infinity Gauntlet</i> #2–6 is adapted beat for beat, and the five-year gap is the showrunner's structural choice. |

##### Straight from the page:

- **Adam Warlock returns and takes command** of the resistance (#2).
- **The cosmic entities gather:** Galactus, the Stranger, Eternity and more (#3–5).
- Warlock's plan: **a frontal assault that's meant to fail**, to exploit **Thanos's need to win, and his need to lose** (#3–4).
- **The heroes' assault. Thanos kills them one by one:** Iron Man, Thor, the Hulk, Wolverine, Namor, the Vision, **Doctor Doom** (who goes for the Gauntlet himself), and more (#4).
- *Captain America stands alone against Thanos* (#4):

*"As long as one man stands against you, you'll never win."*

- **The Silver Surfer lunges for the Gauntlet and misses by an inch** (#4).
- **Thanos leaves his body** to become omnipresent, and **Nebula takes the Gauntlet** (#4).
- **Nebula reverses the last twenty-four hours**, bringing the fallen heroes back, then **has to fight the cosmic entities** (#5).
- **Thanos joins the heroes** against his own granddaughter (#5–6).
- **Warlock takes the Gauntlet and restores reality** (#6).
- **Thanos fakes his death and retires to a farm on a quiet world.** Warlock is the only one who knows (#6).
- **Warlock divides the Gems among the Infinity Watch** (*Warlock and the Infinity Watch* #1).

## Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

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| **The five-year jump** | The showrunner's choice. It lets the film show **the cost** of the snap. |

| **Warlock reverses five years, not a day** | On 616, Warlock and Nebula undo **the Gauntlet's events**. Here the Gauntlet's events **span five years**, so the reversal does too. **The people who fought remember.** |

## POWERS & ABILITIES

| Character                        | 616 powers & abilities                                      | Shown in this film                                                                                             | Held back (why) | Match                                                                                         |
|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Thanos                           | Omnipotent; <b>leaves his body and becomes the universe</b> | <b>He is everywhere at once</b> ; he kills heroes with a thought, and he fights Galactus and Eternity together | –               | <br>100%   |
| Adam Warlock (with the Gauntlet) | Omnipotent                                                  | <b>Rewrites five years of reality</b>                                                                          | –               | <br>100%   |
| Nebula (with the Gauntlet)       | Omnipotent                                                  | <b>Undoes the last day</b> ; fights the cosmic entities                                                        | –               | <br>100%   |
| Captain Marvel (Binary)          | <b>Binary form: cosmic-scale power</b> (616, 1982)          | <b>Goes Binary for the first time</b> and holds Thanos's attention for eleven seconds                          | –               | <br>100% |
| Galactus                         | The Power Cosmic at its limit                               | <b>Fights Thanos directly</b> and loses                                                                        | –               | <br>100% |
| Every hero                       | As in their films                                           | <b>The last stand of their lives</b>                                                                           | –               | <br>100% |

## 4. STORY

| Field                | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Logline              | Five years after half of all life disappeared, the survivors are broken, older and grieving. Then a golden stranger steps out of the Soul Gem with a plan that only works if every one of them is willing to die. |
| Theme                | <b>Forever.</b> Loss is permanent until it isn't, and heroes keep fighting anyway. <i>"As long as one man stands against you, you'll never win."</i>                                                              |
| Villain / antagonist | <b>THANOS</b> ; <b>Nebula</b> (with the Gauntlet); <b>Mephisto</b>                                                                                                                                                |

## What the movie is about

### PROLOGUE: 3:15 PM

- **Saturday, April 28, 2018, one minute after the snap.** The ashes haven't settled.
- **Hank Pym**, on his knees in the rubble, calls **Janet's** name.
- **Pietro** screams for **Wanda**.
- **Tony** stares at the dust where **Peter** was standing.
- **Carol Danvers** lands among them: *"How do we fix this?"* Nobody answers.

### TITLE CARD: FIVE YEARS LATER

### ACT ONE: 2023

- **Monday, April 24, 2023.** Half of Earth is empty. Heroes are **older and grieving**.
- **Cap** runs grief support groups in Brooklyn.
- **Tony** runs a hollowed-out S.H.I.E.L.D. and doesn't sleep.
- **Thor** rules a half-empty Asgard.
- **Hank** is barely functioning.
- **Adam Warlock, Gamora** and **Pip** step out of the Soul Gem (the ending of *Warlock*).
- **WARLOCK:** *"Thanos always leaves himself a way to lose. I'm going to give him one."*
- Warlock gathers **every hero still standing** and the **cosmic entities: Galactus, the Stranger** and **Eternity**.

### ACT TWO: THE LAST STAND

- **Thanos** has **risen out of his body** to become the universe. He comes back to his temple **to face them himself**. He wants to be seen winning.
- **The assault.** Every hero goes all in:
- **Captain Marvel** goes **Binary**.
- **Thor's God Blast**.
- **The Hulk at his peak**.
- **Doom**, who has allied with no one, **goes for the Gauntlet**.
- **Thanos kills them one by one.** Iron Man, Thor, the Hulk, Wolverine, Doom, the Vision, Namor, Carol. Each death is quick.
- The smoke clears. **Captain America stands alone.** His shield is cracked.

**CAP:** *"As long as one man stands against you... you'll never win."*

- **Thanos kills him.**
- **The Silver Surfer** dives for the Gauntlet **and misses by an inch.**

### ACT THREE: THE GAUNTLET

- Thanos, triumphant, **risers out of his body again**, higher than ever.
- **Nebula**, his tortured trophy, **pulls the Gauntlet off his empty hand**.
- **Nebula reverses the last day.** The fallen heroes come back to life on the temple floor.
- Nebula, omnipotent now, **turns on everyone. Galactus, Eternity and the Stranger** fight her, and they're

losing.

- **Thanos**, stripped of godhood and mortal again, walks up to Warlock: "*She'll destroy everything. Let me help you.*"
- Thanos distracts Nebula, and **Warlock takes the Gauntlet**.
- **Warlock**, omnipotent, closes his eyes and **rewinds five years**.

#### EPILOGUE: 3:14 PM

- **Saturday, April 28, 2018, 3:14 PM**. The snap **never happens**. Thanos's fist closes on **nothing**.
  - Everyone who vanished is **back**, as if nothing happened:
  - **Janet** is in Hank's arms. **Hank sobs**. She doesn't understand why.
  - **Wanda** turns around to find **Pietro** crushing her in a hug.
  - **Peter Parker** asks Tony why he's crying.
  - **Only the heroes who fought remember the five years**.
  - **Thanos** fakes his death in the temple. **Only Warlock sees him leave**.
  - **A quiet farm on a distant world**. Thanos, in plain clothes, plants seeds. **Death** stands at the edge of the field. **She watches him for a long time**. Then she leaves, and **he doesn't follow**.
  - **May 2019. Avengers Mansion**.
  - **Cap** is pardoned. **Tony** gives the Mansion back to the team.
  - **Every Avenger**, old and new, gathers on the steps.
  - **CAP: "Avengers... ASSEMBLE."**
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## 5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

| Field                   | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| When it's set           | <b>Prologue:</b> Saturday, April 28, 2018, 3:15 PM ET · <b>Main story:</b> Monday, April 24, 2023 → Saturday, May 27, 2023 · <b>Epilogue:</b> Saturday, April 28, 2018, 3:14 PM (the reversal) and May 2019                                |
| Where it's set          | <b>Avengers Mansion</b> · <b>a ruined New York, 2023</b> · <b>Thanos's temple</b> · <b>a farm on a distant world</b> (filmed on location in New York, Iceland, Jordan and Georgia)                                                         |
| Relative to other films | <b>A direct sequel to <i>The Infinity Gauntlet</i></b> . It <b>picks up from Warlock's ending</b> . The <b>five years were undone</b> , so the <b>MCU timeline carries on from April 2018</b> into <i>The Amazing Spider-Man 2</i> (2019). |

**Canon rule (locked):** the five-year gap (2018–2023) **never happened for the world**. The heroes who fought in 2023 **remember it**. That includes Tony, Cap, Thor, the Hulk, Hank, Carol, the Widow, Hawkeye, Pietro, the Vision, the Surfer, Strange, Warlock, Gamora, Nebula and Thanos.

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## 6. WORLD-BUILDING

### The film's own world

- **The five lost years**, remembered by the few.
- **The Infinity Watch**: Warlock divides the Gems among trusted guardians, including **Gamora** and **Drax** (616).
- **Thanos, the farmer**.

### World-building for the wider MCU

| Seed                           | How it appears                  | Payoff                          |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| <b>The Avengers reunited</b>   | Civil War ends; Cap is pardoned | After the saga                  |
| <b>Everyone restored</b>       | The vanished are back           | <i>The Amazing Spider-Man 2</i> |
| <b>The heroes who remember</b> | Five years only they carry      | After the saga                  |

### THE BIG BAD: RESOLVED

- **Thanos loses because of his own flaw**, as Starlin wrote it: he **always leaves himself a way to lose**.
  - **Death never chose him**.
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## 7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

| Field                         | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Mid-credit scene</b>       | ✓ <b>"THE WATCH."</b> Warlock gives the Gems away, one by one: <b>Time to Gamora, Power to Drax, Space to Pip</b> . He keeps <b>Soul</b> . Mind and Reality go to guardians whose names he keeps secret. Pip: <i>"Why do I get the boring one?"</i> |
| <b>Post-credit scene</b>      | ✓ <b>"FOR STAN."</b> No scene. <b>A photo of Stan Lee</b> on set, grinning and giving a thumbs-up. <b>"EXCELSIOR!"</b>                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Secret shoot codenames</b> | Mid-credit: <b>"SECRET SANTA."</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |

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## CHECKLIST

- [x] Comic(s) adapted · [x] Comic Accuracy Report + powers · [x] Real and decoy titles · [x] What it's about · [x] Villain · [x] Post-credit scenes · [x] The film's own world-building · [x] MCU world-building

· [x] Big Bad setup (resolved) · [x] Whose franchise · [x] When and where in the timeline · [x] **Five-year time jump shortly after the start**